PHISHING EMAIL DETECTION
&
AWARENESS REPORT

INTRODUCTION

This report presents an analysis of email samples to identify phishing attempts and assess associated risks. Phishing attacks are one of the most common cybersecurity threats where attackers trick users into revealing sensitive information such as passwords, OTPs, and personal data.

The objective of this report is to analyse email samples, identify phishing indicators, classify risk levels, and provide awareness guidelines to prevent such attacks.

EMAIL ANALYSIS

- **Email 1 — Phishing Email**

Subject: Urgent: Your Bank Account Will Be Locked

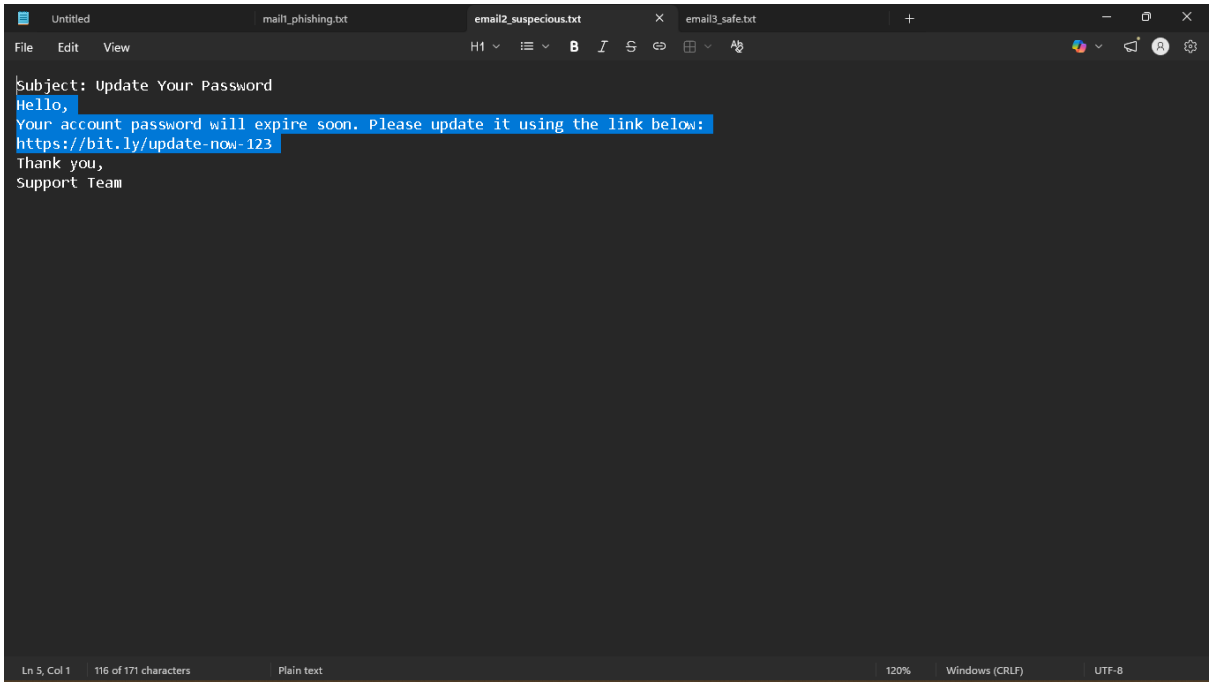
Indicators Identified:

- Use of urgent and fear-based language
- Suspicious and untrusted link
- Generic greeting (“Dear Customer”)

Risk Level: HIGH

Analysis:

This email attempts to create panic and pressure the user into clicking a malicious link. The URL does not belong to a legitimate domain and may lead to a fake login page designed to steal user credentials.



- **Email 2 — Suspicious Email**

Subject: Update Your Password

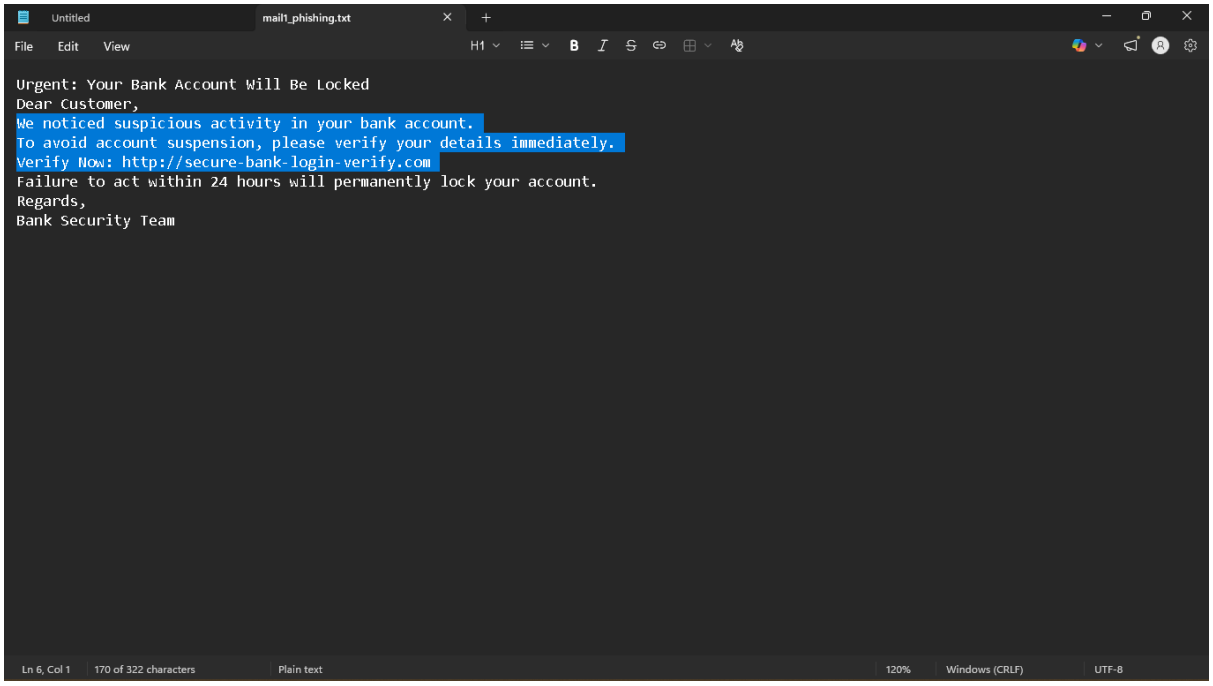
Indicators Identified:

- Use of shortened URL (bit.ly)
- Lack of proper sender identification
- Slight urgency in message

Risk Level: MEDIUM

Analysis:

The email contains a shortened link which hides the actual destination. Such links are commonly used in phishing attacks. Although not fully confirmed as malicious, it should be treated with caution.



- **Email 3 — Safe Email**

Subject: Welcome to Our Platform

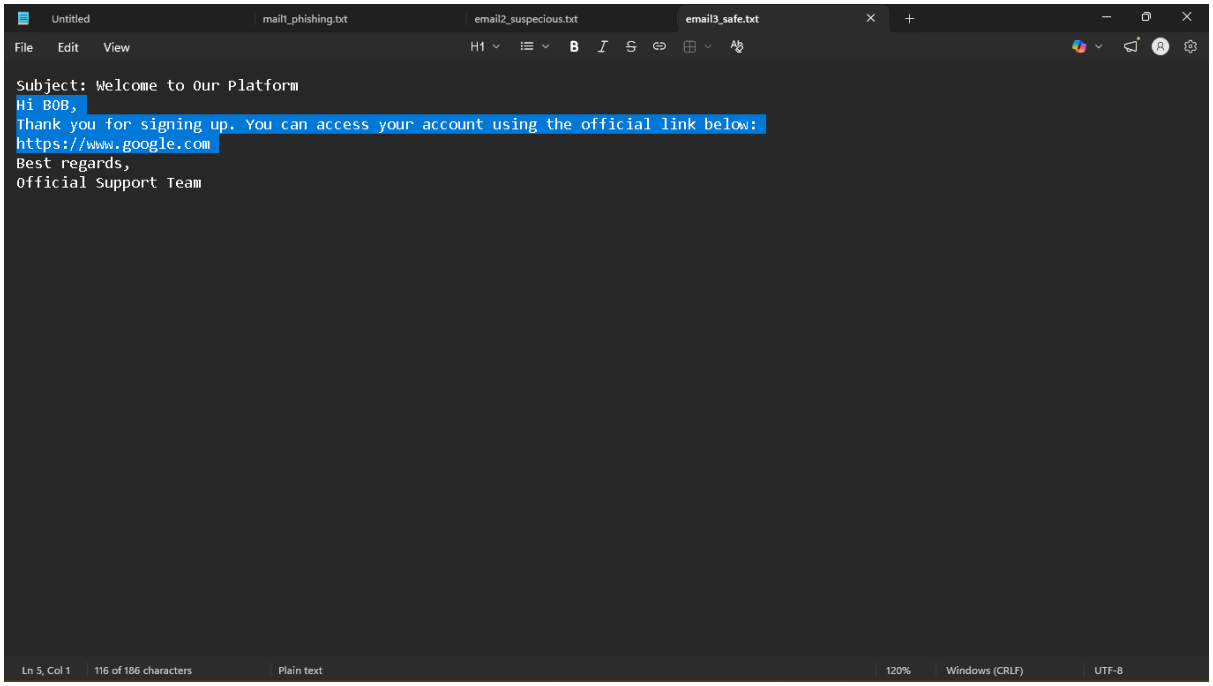
Indicators Identified:

- Personalized greeting
- Legitimate and trusted URL
- No urgency or suspicious language

Risk Level: LOW

Analysis:

This email appears to be legitimate. It uses a trusted domain and does not attempt to create urgency or manipulate the user.



AWARENESS & PREVENTION

- How Phishing Attacks Work

Phishing emails trick users by impersonating trusted organizations. They create urgency or fear to force users into clicking malicious links or sharing sensitive information.

Do's (Best Practices)

- Always verify the sender's email address
- Hover over links before clicking
- Use official websites instead of email links
- Report suspicious emails immediately

Don'ts (Avoid These)

- Do not click unknown or shortened links
- Do not share passwords or OTPs via email
- Do not trust urgent messages blindly
- Do not download attachments from unknown sources

CONCLUSION

Phishing attacks rely heavily on user awareness rather than technical vulnerabilities. By identifying common phishing indicators such as suspicious links, urgency, and fake domains, users can effectively prevent such attacks.